

Named Entity Recognition(NER)

Any word which represents a person, organization, location etc. is a Named Entity. Named entity recognition is a subtask of Information Extraction and is the process of identifying words which are named entities in a given text. It is also called entity identification or entity chunking

Example

"Apple acquired Zoom in China on Wednesday 6th May 2020"

- Here named entities are Apple, Zoom, China and Wednesday 6th May 2020"
- Named entity recognition is the task of identifying these words from the text

Why it is important?

In order to understand the meaning from a given text (for ex a tweet or document), it is important to identify who did what to whom. Named entity recognition is the first task of identifying the words which may represent the who, what and whom in the text. It helps in identifying the major entities the text is talking about

Any NLP task which involves automatically understanding text and acts based on it, needs Named Entity Recognition in its pipeline

Caveat

No algorithm can 100% identify all the named entities correctly

Three approaches

- Basic NLTK algorithm
 - with word segmentation
 - with sentence segmentation
- Stanford NLP NER
- Using Spacy